g-IGNITE – Fueling India's AI Future
Hackathon General Rules & Guidelines

Event Overview

Organized by	Gadgeon Smart Systems Pvt. Ltd. As part of its 15th Anniversary celebrations
In Collaboration with	IEEE Signal Processing Society (SPS) Kerala Chapter
Host Institution	Federal Institute of Science and Technology (FISAT), Angamaly
Final Round	24-Hour Offline AI Hackathon
Eligibility	Students from professional engineering colleges across Kerala

Hackathon Structure

Stage 1 – Team formation & Idea Submission

Stage 2 – Offline Grand Finale

Hackathon Themes

Participants should identify problems and build AI-based solutions within one of the following theme areas.

- AI for Healthcare
- AI for Mobility & Transportation
- AI for Disaster Management
- AI for Smart Cities
- Open Innovation Track

Eligibility

- Open to students from engineering colleges across Kerala.
- Students from any engineering streams can participate.

General Rules

Team Formation Rules

- Each team must have minimum of 2 and maximum of 5 members.
- Teams must be made up exclusively of participants who are not organizers, volunteers, judges, or otherwise in a privileged position at the event.
- All team members must belong to the same college. Multi college team formation is not allowed.
- Each participant may be a member of only one registered g-IGNITE team.
- Team composition must be finalized before the stage 1 submission. Any request to add, remove, or replace a team member after registration must be submitted to the Organizing Committee and will be subject to approval.

Idea Submission Rules

- Teams must submit ideas under one of the five g-IGNITE challenge themes. Identify a meaningful real-world problem within your selected theme.
- Your submission should clearly cover: Problem Statement, Proposed Solution, AI approach / technology, expected impact along with a PDF/PPT format document (Template will be available on the platform to download)
- Each team may submit only one idea for the g-IGNITE hackathon. Multiple idea submissions from the same team will not be accepted.
- Once a Stage 1 submission has been made, the selected hackathon theme and submitted idea cannot be changed.

Grand Finale Rules

- Shortlisted teams will be invited to compete in the Grand Finale.
- Teams will have 24 hours to build their working prototype. All project development, from initiation to implementation, must be carried out within the 24-hour hackathon window.
- Participants are allowed to use their choice of tech stacks.
- No pre-built codebases to be used. This includes, but is not limited existing GitHub repositories, personal GitHub boilerplates, previously developed personal code, college project code, code generated before the hackathon or AI-generated code prepared before the event.
- Open-source libraries and publicly available APIs are permitted.
- Participants may use publicly available or licenced accounts of Generative AI tools for activities such as brainstorming, research, documentation, content refinement, coding assistance, debugging, or development planning.

- Final submissions must include a working prototype; slides or concepts alone will not qualify.
- Organizers may conduct code/commit-timestamp validation to confirm the project was built within the given time frame.
- Participants are responsible for bringing their own laptops, chargers, required software, development tools, libraries, datasets, APIs, and any other resources or assets necessary for the hackathon. The organizers will provide electricity/power and internet connectivity at the designated venue.
- Participants are responsible for ensuring that their devices, software, accounts, licenses, credentials, and other required resources are ready and functional before the hackathon begins.

Originality & Code Ownership

- The idea submitted by the team must be their own original concept or a legitimate adaptation/application of a publicly known problem or challenge. The proposed solution and approach must demonstrate the team's own originality and contribution.
- All code developed must be the team's original work developed for g-IGNITE.

Participation & Conduct

- The Team Leader will be responsible for ensuring that all team members receive and follow official communications, instructions, and updates from the Organizing Committee.
- All registered team members must participate in the finale event.
- At least one team member must remain present at the designated team area during the finale hackathon, subject to the break and safety guidelines communicated by the Organizers.
- Cross-team collaboration is not allowed during the finale competition. Teams must not share code, solutions, datasets, technical implementations, or development assistance with other participating teams during the competition
- Teams are encouraged to seek advice and support from g-IGNITE mentors, organizers, or volunteers when required. Teams may seek guidance from designated mentors; however, mentors will provide guidance only and will not develop or implement the solution on behalf of a team.
- Teams must stop development activities when the announced hackathon period ends. Any submission or code update made after the official deadline may not be considered
- Participants must follow a Code of Conduct that promotes inclusivity, respect, and professionalism. Harassment, discrimination, or inappropriate behaviour will not be tolerated.
- Any form of cheating, plagiarism, or unfair practice will result in immediate disqualification.

- Organizers reserve the right to disqualify a team at their discretion for breach of these rules or the Code of Conduct.
- Discrimination of teams based on race, religion, national origin, colour, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, social class, economic status, disability, or age will not be allowed by the organizers.
- The possession, consumption, or use of alcohol, drugs, tobacco, or other prohibited substances is strictly prohibited throughout the hackathon. Violations may result in disqualification and removal from the event.
- There will be no Travel allowance provided to participants for attending the hackathon.
- Food, snacks, and basic resting facilities will be provided by the organizers throughout the 24-hour hackathon.

Intellectual Property & Media

- Participants retain ownership of their intellectual property. By participating, teams grant the organizers a non-exclusive, royalty-free right to display and communicate submitted project information, screenshots, demonstrations and non-confidential project materials for hackathon-related promotional, educational and showcase purposes.
- Organizers may request teams to share code or project details for promotional or showcase purposes.
- Participants may be required to consent to the use of photographs, videos, or project details for promotional or media purposes.

Prizes, Disputes & Liability

- Winning teams will be recognised with prizes/awards as communicated by the organizer.
- There will be three prizes overall (First, Second, and Third); there are no separate theme-wise prizes.
- The decision of the judging panel is final.
- Organizers and volunteers hold no liability for damages, losses, or injuries during the event; participants are responsible for their own safety and equipment.
- The Organizing Committee reserves the right to make reasonable changes to the event schedule, operational arrangements, rules or prizes where necessary. Any material changes affecting participants will be communicated through the official event communication channels.
- If any rule is unclear, or you are unsure whether something is permitted, please contact the organizers for clarification through gignite@gadgeon.com.

Data Privacy & Confidentiality

The personal information and details submitted by participants for g-IGNITE will be handled confidentially by the Organizers and used only for purposes related to the hackathon, including registration, communication, evaluation, event coordination and administration.

Stage 1 – Mandatory Requirements & Evaluation Parameters

Team must have below mentioned details to quality for the stage 2.

- Clear details of team and supporting documents such as college id card uploaded to the registration portal.
- Clearly defined problem statement aligned with one of the five approved hackathon themes.
- Clearly defined AI/ML component explaining how AI will be used to address the proposed problem.
- Proposed solution that directly addresses the identified problem.
- Clear explanation of the feasibility and potential scalability of the proposed solution.
- All required Stage 1 materials should be submitted before the registration deadline.

Evaluation Parameters

Parameter	What is assessed
Problem Relevance	How well the solution addresses a genuine, well-articulated problem within the chosen AI theme.
AI Approach & Technology usage	Depth and difficulty of the AI techniques used; correctness and robustness of the technology used for creating the solution.
Clarity of the solution deck	Clarity of the deck and how well the team explained the problem, solution, and impact.
Innovation & Creativity	Originality of the approach, novel use of technology, or a creative angle on a known problem.
Feasibility & Scalability	Practicality of real-world deployment with in 24 hour and scalability to create the prototype.

***** Detailed evaluation parameters for the Grand Finale will be communicated separately to all shortlisted teams *****

Bring your ideas & innovation to the forefront and make your mark at g-IGNITE.

All the very best to every team.